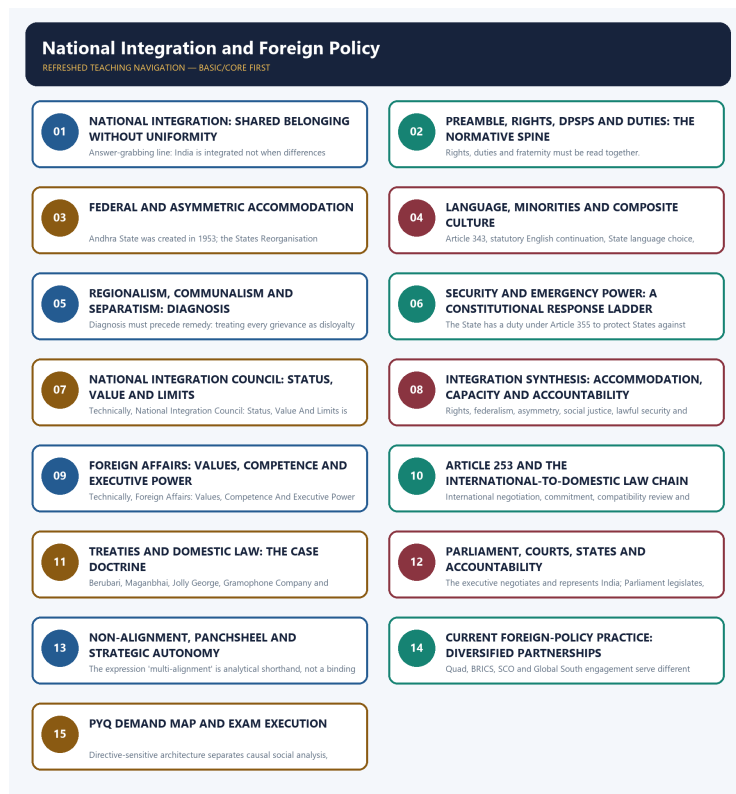


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

National Integration and Foreign Policy - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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National Integration and Foreign Policy - Solved Practice Workbook

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Original MCQs 1-36 - Broad Coverage

OM1. National integration is best understood as

- A. equal constitutional membership across legitimate diversity
- B. only territorial control
- C. absence of regional identities
- D. cultural uniformity imposed by law

Answer: A

Explanation: Integration combines shared belonging with protected diversity.

OM2. Which Preamble value expressly links dignity with national cohesion?

- A. republic
- B. fraternity
- C. adult suffrage
- D. socialism

Answer: B

Explanation: Fraternity assures dignity and the unity and integrity of the nation.

OM3. Which provision protects a distinct language, script or culture?

- A. Article 23
- B. Article 360
- C. Article 29
- D. Article 17

Answer: C

Explanation: Article 29 protects cultural interests.

OM4. Which duty concerns harmony and common brotherhood?

- A. Article 51A(a)
- B. Article 51A(j)
- C. Article 51A(h)
- D. Article 51A(e)

Answer: D

Explanation: Article 51A(e) addresses harmony across diversities.

OM5. Linguistic reorganisation primarily illustrates

- A. integration by accommodation
- B. judicial legislation
- C. constitutional emergency
- D. external session

Answer: A

Explanation: Internal borders accommodated language claims within the Union.

OM6. Which mechanism gives autonomous district arrangements in parts of the North-East?

- A. Twelfth Schedule
- B. Sixth Schedule
- C. Tenth Schedule
- D. Ninth Schedule

Answer: B

Explanation: The Sixth Schedule provides autonomous district and regional councils.

OM7. Which is an exam-safe distinction?

- A. dissent is disloyalty
- B. religious identity is communalism
- C. regional identity is not necessarily secessionism
- D. migration proves collective guilt

Answer: C

Explanation: Identity and unconstitutional mobilisation must not be conflated.

OM8. Article 355 concerns the Union's duty to

- A. appoint the NIC
- B. create linguistic minorities
- C. ratify treaties
- D. protect States and ensure constitutional government

Answer: D

Explanation: Article 355 states the protective and constitutional-government duty.

OM9. The National Integration Council is

- A. extra-constitutional, non-statutory and advisory
- B. a constitutional commission
- C. a parliamentary committee
- D. a statutory tribunal

Answer: A

Explanation: The NIC has no constitutional or statutory status.

OM10. The latest officially located NIC meeting used in this package occurred in

- A. 2024
- B. 2013
- C. 1961
- D. 1990

Answer: B

Explanation: The sixteenth meeting was held on 23 September 2013.

OM11. Which claim is most defensible?

- A. NIC was constitutionally abolished
- B. NIC controls State police
- C. irregular advisory follow-up limits the NIC
- D. NIC directions bind courts

Answer: C

Explanation: Its advisory nature and irregularity limit implementation.

OM12. Which response best supports durable integration?

- A. suppression of every regional demand
- B. permanent emergency
- C. collective punishment
- D. graded accommodation, development, lawful security and review

Answer: D

Explanation: A differentiated constitutional response avoids overbreadth.

OM13. Article 51 is located among the

- A. Directive Principles of State Policy
- B. Fundamental Rights
- C. Fundamental Duties
- D. Emergency Provisions

Answer: A

Explanation: Article 51 is a non-justiciable DPSP.

OM14. Union foreign-affairs competence is detailed chiefly through

- A. Article 324
- B. Article 246 and Union List Entries 10-21
- C. State List Entries 1-5
- D. Article 280 alone

Answer: B

Explanation: Foreign affairs and related subjects are in the Union List.

OM15. Article 73 extends Union executive power to

- A. every municipal subject without limit
- B. judicial review alone
- C. parliamentary fields and treaty-derived rights or jurisdiction
- D. constitutional amendment

Answer: C

Explanation: This is the textually accurate scope.

OM16. Article 253 empowers

- A. States alone to ratify treaties
- B. the NIC to legislate
- C. courts to sign agreements
- D. Parliament to implement international obligations notwithstanding ordinary distribution

Answer: D

Explanation: Article 253 is an overriding implementation competence.

OM17. Which statement about treaties is accurate?

- A. international commitment and domestic legal effect are distinct
- B. every treaty automatically overrides statutes
- C. all treaties require State ratification
- D. Article 51 self-executes treaties

Answer: A

Explanation: Domestic implementation depends on constitutional and legal compatibility.

OM18. Berubari is authority for the proposition that

- A. all boundary surveys need amendment
- B. cession of Indian territory requires constitutional amendment
- C. courts negotiate treaties
- D. Article 3 governs foreign cession

Answer: B

Explanation: External cession is distinct from internal boundary alteration.

OM19. Maganbhai chiefly helps distinguish

- A. religion from language
- B. DPSPs from duties
- C. executive implementation under existing law from law-changing action
- D. NIC from ISC

Answer: C

Explanation: It addresses implementation and need for legislation.

OM20. Jolly George Varghese rejected

- A. all use of international law
- B. parliamentary treaty legislation
- C. judicial review
- D. automatic override of inconsistent domestic law by a covenant

Answer: D

Explanation: International covenants do not automatically displace municipal law.

OM21. Gramophone Company supports

- A. harmonious use of international law where domestic law is not contrary
- B. automatic treaty supremacy
- C. foreign judicial control
- D. State treaty veto

Answer: A

Explanation: Municipal law prevails where conflict exists.

OM22. Vishaka used international norms to

- A. cede territory
- B. fill a domestic-law vacuum consistently with Fundamental Rights
- C. suspend Article 14
- D. create the NIC

Answer: B

Explanation: International norms aided rights-consistent gap filling.

OM23. Parliament's foreign-affairs role includes

- A. no constitutional function
- B. treaty negotiation exclusively
- C. legislation, finance, debate and committees
- D. only ceremonial addresses

Answer: C

Explanation: Executive primacy does not erase legislative functions.

OM24. Where treaties substantially affect State administration, the best reform is

- A. secret implementation
- B. automatic nullity
- C. judicial treaty negotiation
- D. structured consultation without a State veto

Answer: D

Explanation: Consultation supports federal implementation while preserving Union competence.

OM25. Panchsheel was placed in the preamble of a 1954 agreement concerning

- A. trade and intercourse with the Tibet region of China
- B. the UN Charter
- C. the Commonwealth
- D. SAARC

Answer: A

Explanation: This is the historical instrument.

OM26. Non-alignment means

- A. membership in no organisation
- B. independent judgment rather than bloc subordination
- C. neutrality in every conflict
- D. international isolation

Answer: B

Explanation: NAM was a policy of decision independence.

OM27. Strategic autonomy is best described as

- A. equal distance from every State
- B. constitutional neutrality
- C. decision independence supported by diversified partnerships and capability
- D. withdrawal from trade

Answer: C

Explanation: Autonomy is compatible with partnerships.

OM28. The phrase multi-alignment should be treated as

- A. a UN treaty
- B. a constitutional amendment
- C. a judicial command
- D. analytical shorthand rather than binding doctrine

Answer: D

Explanation: Officially grounded strategic autonomy is safer.

OM29. Quad, BRICS and SCO together illustrate

- A. issue-based cooperation across different groupings
- B. abandonment of autonomy
- C. one collective-defence alliance
- D. identical memberships

Answer: A

Explanation: Their different purposes demonstrate diversified engagement.

OM30. The third Voice of Global South Summit was hosted in

- A. December 2022
- B. August 2024
- C. March 2026
- D. January 2020

Answer: B

Explanation: India hosted it virtually on 17 August 2024.

OM31. Which is a sound current-affairs practice?

- A. omit the source
- B. freeze every membership count
- C. date and source the example and connect it to a theme
- D. treat rhetoric as law

Answer: C

Explanation: Dated primary evidence avoids stale claims.

OM32. Which statement about Article 51 is false?

- A. it mentions arbitration
- B. it promotes international peace
- C. it is a DPSP
- D. it is the sole enforceable source of treaty power

Answer: D

Explanation: Article 51 is a value directive, not enforceable treaty competence.

OM33. Article 351 concerns

- A. development and promotion of Hindi
- B. foreign cession
- C. treaty implementation
- D. NIC meetings

Answer: A

Explanation: It must be read with plural language arrangements.

OM34. Article 350B provides for

- A. Inter-State Council
- B. Special Officer for Linguistic Minorities
- C. Attorney General
- D. CAG

Answer: B

Explanation: The office reports on linguistic-minority safeguards.

OM35. Secularism and federalism were emphasised as basic features in

- A. Berubari
- B. Jolly George
- C. S. R. Bommai
- D. Vishaka

Answer: C

Explanation: Bommai is central to emergency and federal review.

OM36. A sound integration answer should avoid

- A. distinguishing identity from mobilisation
- B. using a qualified verdict
- C. linking rights and duties
- D. equating dissent with disloyalty

Answer: D

Explanation: Conflation produces constitutional and analytical error.

Remedial MCQs 37-48 - Close-Option Control

RM1. The 2018 communalism PYQ demands

- A. argument using power struggle or relative deprivation with illustrations
- B. only a definition of NIC
- C. a diaspora balance sheet
- D. a list of treaties

Answer: A

Explanation: The directive requires causal argument and examples.

RM2. The 2022 BIMSTEC PYQ requires

- A. only expansion of acronyms
- B. comparison with SAARC and linkage to Indian objectives
- C. constitutional cession doctrine
- D. a NAM history

Answer: B

Explanation: All three components must be answered.

RM3. The 2023 ethnic-identity PYQ connects communalism to

- A. the 1954 treaty alone
- B. NIC composition
- C. the post-liberal economy
- D. Article 253 only

Answer: C

Explanation: It requires a political-economy mechanism.

RM4. The 2023 diaspora PYQ asks for

- A. a critique of SAARC
- B. only remittance figures
- C. only consular crises
- D. economic and political benefits for India

Answer: D

Explanation: Both dimensions must be covered.

RM5. Which answer structure is strongest for communalism?

- A. define, causal mechanisms, illustrations, qualification and remedy
- B. unqualified slogan
- C. constitutional articles without mechanism
- D. chronology only

Answer: A

Explanation: Directive-sensitive causal analysis earns marks.

RM6. Which answer structure is strongest for strategic autonomy?

- A. one current event without analysis
- B. interests, instruments, dated evidence, constraints and verdict
- C. grouping names only
- D. Nehru quotations only

Answer: B

Explanation: It connects doctrine to executable evidence.

RM7. Diaspora influence should be qualified by

- A. absence of political risk
- B. constitutional voting in India by all diaspora
- C. host-State law and diverse diaspora interests
- D. automatic control of foreign governments

Answer: C

Explanation: Diasporas are plural and operate under host-country institutions.

RM8. Energy security affects foreign policy through

- A. linguistic reorganisation
- B. Article 51A alone
- C. NIC membership
- D. supplier diversification, logistics, prices and strategic choices

Answer: D

Explanation: Energy dependence creates external-policy constraints.

RM9. Which reform best addresses treaty accountability?

- A. publication, impact assessment and parliamentary scrutiny
- B. abolish Article 253
- C. State unanimity for all talks
- D. automatic judicial ratification

Answer: A

Explanation: Scrutiny can coexist with executive negotiation.

RM10. Which claim about Article 253 is wrong?

- A. it can reach State subjects
- B. it gives each State a veto over treaty implementation
- C. it covers international decisions
- D. it empowers Parliament

Answer: B

Explanation: The provision overrides ordinary federal distribution.

RM11. The strongest synthesis is

- A. foreign policy has no domestic foundation
- B. uniformity guarantees unity
- C. domestic inclusion builds resilience while strategic autonomy protects external choice
- D. security removes accountability

Answer: C

Explanation: Integration and foreign policy are mutually reinforcing.

RM12. A qualified final verdict should emphasise

- A. unreviewable executive power
- B. cultural erasure
- C. permanent exception
- D. constitutional inclusion, capable institutions and accountable flexibility

Answer: D

Explanation: The package's central evaluative standard joins legitimacy and capacity.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED DIRECT PYQ 1 - 2018 GS-I - 10 marks - 150 words

Question (exact): “‘Communalism arises either due to power struggle or relative deprivation.’ Argue by giving suitable illustrations.”

Model answer: Communalism is the political mobilisation of religious identity through antagonistic group claims. Power struggle explains it when elites use polarisation to consolidate votes, displace rivals or control institutions. Competitive religious appeals, hate campaigns and local contest over offices can convert ordinary difference into a zero-sum conflict.

Relative deprivation explains mobilisation when a group perceives that its status, security or access has declined compared with another group or with its own expectations. Economic transition, uneven urbanisation and rumours about preferential treatment can supply such perceptions even when objective deprivation is mixed.

The two mechanisms interact: political entrepreneurs frame employment, land or representation anxieties as religious injury. Communalism is therefore neither an automatic product of faith nor reducible to poverty.

The remedy must combine impartial law enforcement, equal opportunity, civic education, local dialogue and accountability for incitement. Constitutional fraternity requires transforming distributive and political conflict into democratic bargaining rather than collective blame.

Why this earns marks: It defines the phenomenon, argues both stated causes, explains interaction and supplies a constitutional remedy.

How to improve this answer: Add one precisely recalled Indian illustration for each mechanism; do not treat every religious dispute as communalism.

Compression guidance: Keep definition, two causal paragraphs, interaction, two remedies and verdict.

VERIFIED SUPPORTING PYQ 2 - 2022 GS-II - 10 marks - 150 words

Question (exact): “Do you think that BIMSTEC is a parallel organisation like the SAARC? What are the similarities and dissimilarities between the two? How are Indian foreign policy objectives realized by forming this new organisation?”

Model answer: BIMSTEC and SAARC are regional cooperation organisations, but BIMSTEC is not merely a parallel copy. Both seek functional cooperation, development and connectivity and include South Asian members. SAARC is South Asia-wide and includes Pakistan and Afghanistan; BIMSTEC links South and Southeast Asia around the Bay of Bengal and excludes Pakistan.

BIMSTEC supports India's Neighbourhood First and Act East policies by connecting its eastern and north-eastern regions to Bay of Bengal economies. Sectoral cooperation can advance connectivity, trade, energy, disaster management, security and people-to-people ties. It also offers a forum less constrained by India-Pakistan deadlock.

However, weak institutional capacity, delayed agreements, connectivity deficits and political instability limit delivery. BIMSTEC should complement rather than mechanically replace SAARC.

Thus, its value lies in a distinct geography and functional agenda that widens India's strategic options while requiring stronger implementation.

Why this earns marks: It answers similarity, dissimilarity and Indian objectives, then qualifies institutional performance.

How to improve this answer: Add one dated summit or agreement only if accurately recalled; avoid saying BIMSTEC was created solely to isolate Pakistan.

Compression guidance: Use two similarities, three differences, four objectives, two limits and verdict.

VERIFIED DIRECT PYQ 3 - 2023 GS-I - 15 marks - 250 words

Question (exact): "Discuss the impact of post-liberal economy on ethnic identity and communalism."

Model answer: Economic liberalisation widened mobility, markets, media and aspirational consumption. It also produced uneven gains across regions, occupations and social groups. These changes reshape ethnic identity and communalism through contradictory mechanisms.

First, migration and urbanisation create mixed workplaces and networks that can weaken inherited boundaries. New middle classes, digital communication and national markets can support identities based on profession, consumption and citizenship.

Second, uneven development intensifies relative deprivation. Competition over jobs, land, housing, welfare and political representation may be framed through regional, caste, linguistic or religious identities. Local elites can convert distributive conflict into ethnic or communal mobilisation.

Third, commercial media and social platforms allow rapid cultural assertion but also profitable polarisation, rumours and targeted hate. Fourth, market-led displacement and insecure informal work can produce anxieties that exclusionary movements redirect against migrants or minorities.

The outcome is not economically predetermined. Inclusive growth, portable welfare, fair urban governance, anti-discrimination, regional fiscal balance, credible policing and platform accountability mediate it.

Therefore, the post-liberal economy simultaneously creates cross-cutting integration and new identity insecurity. Constitutional policy must distribute opportunity and provide democratic channels so that economic competition does not become collective blame.

Why this earns marks: It presents both integrating and fragmenting mechanisms and identifies mediating institutions.

How to improve this answer: Add one regional or urban example and explicitly separate ethnicity from communalism if space permits.

Compression guidance: Retain four mechanisms, two counter-effects, policy mediation and the qualified verdict.

VERIFIED DIRECT PYQ 4 - 2023 GS-II - 10 marks - 150 words

Question (exact): "Indian diaspora has scaled new heights in the West. Describe its economic and political benefits for India."

Model answer: The Indian diaspora in Western countries benefits India economically through remittances, investment, entrepreneurship, technology and professional networks. It connects Indian firms and institutions to capital, skills, research ecosystems and markets and can support philanthropy and crisis relief.

Politically, elected representatives, professionals and civic organisations can improve knowledge of India, support closer bilateral ties and create constituencies for cooperation in education, technology, security and mobility. Diaspora achievement also contributes to India's reputation and soft power.

These benefits are neither automatic nor uniform. Diaspora communities have diverse political views, operate under host-country law and may face racism, visa insecurity or conflicts over homeland politics. India should therefore prioritise consular protection, skills and investment channels and respectful cultural engagement rather than expect political loyalty.

The diaspora is best treated as a bridge of people and capability, not an instrument controlled by the Indian State.

Why this earns marks: It covers both named dimensions, provides mechanisms and adds a realistic qualification.

How to improve this answer: Include one precise sectoral example rather than an uncertain aggregate statistic.

Compression guidance: Use five economic benefits, three political benefits, one caveat and verdict.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE 1 - 10 marks - 150 words

Question: National integration in India is better understood as accommodation than assimilation. Examine.

Model answer: Begin with a precise thesis responsive to the directive. Define both models; use linguistic States, minority rights, asymmetric federalism and common citizenship; conclude that calibrated accommodation needs equal rights and state capacity. Use constitutional provisions or dated evidence only where they advance the demand. End with a qualified verdict joining legitimacy, institutional capacity and accountability.

Why this earns marks: The answer has a directive-sensitive thesis, an executable evidence order, a limitation and a qualified conclusion.

How to improve this answer: Convert the stated spine into mark-scaled paragraphs and add one precisely recalled authority; do not substitute a generic foreign-policy or unity essay.

Compression guidance: Preserve the thesis, four strongest evidence units, one counterpoint and the verdict.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE 2 - 15 marks - 250 words

Question: Examine the constitutional architecture through which India manages regionalism, communalism and separatism.

Model answer: Begin with a precise thesis responsive to the directive. Organise by diagnosis, rights, federal accommodation, development, security limits, Articles 355-356 and judicial review; separate legitimate identity from violence. Use constitutional provisions or dated evidence only where they advance the demand. End with a qualified verdict joining legitimacy, institutional capacity and accountability.

Why this earns marks: The answer has a directive-sensitive thesis, an executable evidence order, a limitation and a qualified conclusion.

How to improve this answer: Convert the stated spine into mark-scaled paragraphs and add one precisely recalled authority; do not substitute a generic foreign-policy or unity essay.

Compression guidance: Preserve the thesis, four strongest evidence units, one counterpoint and the verdict.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE 3 - 10 marks - 150 words

Question: Is the National Integration Council still institutionally relevant? Comment.

Model answer: Begin with a precise thesis responsive to the directive. State its non-statutory advisory status and 2013 latest located meeting; assess deliberative value and weak follow-up; propose reconstitution or equivalent accountable federal consultation. Use constitutional provisions or dated evidence only where they advance the demand. End with a qualified verdict joining legitimacy, institutional capacity and accountability.

Why this earns marks: The answer has a directive-sensitive thesis, an executable evidence order, a limitation and a qualified conclusion.

How to improve this answer: Convert the stated spine into mark-scaled paragraphs and add one precisely recalled authority; do not substitute a generic foreign-policy or unity essay.

Compression guidance: Preserve the thesis, four strongest evidence units, one counterpoint and the verdict.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE 4 - 15 marks - 250 words

Question: Article 51 states values but does not exhaust the constitutional foundations of Indian foreign policy. Discuss.

Model answer: Begin with a precise thesis responsive to the directive. Pair Article 51 with Articles 73, 246 and 253 and Union List Entries 10-21; distinguish value, competence, executive action and implementation. Use constitutional provisions or dated evidence only where they advance the demand. End with a qualified verdict joining legitimacy, institutional capacity and accountability.

Why this earns marks: The answer has a directive-sensitive thesis, an executable evidence order, a limitation and a qualified conclusion.

How to improve this answer: Convert the stated spine into mark-scaled paragraphs and add one precisely recalled authority; do not substitute a generic foreign-policy or unity essay.

Compression guidance: Preserve the thesis, four strongest evidence units, one counterpoint and the verdict.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE 5 - 15 marks - 250 words

Question: India's treaty practice combines executive flexibility with a democratic-accountability gap. Critically examine.

Model answer: Begin with a precise thesis responsive to the directive. Explain negotiation, international obligation, domestic-law test, Parliament's legislative and financial roles, case doctrine, federal effects and scrutiny reforms. Use constitutional provisions or dated evidence only where they advance the demand. End with a qualified verdict joining legitimacy, institutional capacity and accountability.

Why this earns marks: The answer has a directive-sensitive thesis, an executable evidence order, a limitation and a qualified conclusion.

How to improve this answer: Convert the stated spine into mark-scaled paragraphs and add one precisely recalled authority; do not substitute a generic foreign-policy or unity essay.

Compression guidance: Preserve the thesis, four strongest evidence units, one counterpoint and the verdict.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE 6 - 10 marks - 150 words

Question: Distinguish non-alignment, neutrality and strategic autonomy.

Model answer: Begin with a precise thesis responsive to the directive. Define all three; show continuity of independent judgment and change in partnerships and capability; avoid calling multi-alignment a binding doctrine. Use constitutional provisions or dated evidence only where they advance the demand. End with a qualified verdict joining legitimacy, institutional capacity and accountability.

Why this earns marks: The answer has a directive-sensitive thesis, an executable evidence order, a limitation and a qualified conclusion.

How to improve this answer: Convert the stated spine into mark-scaled paragraphs and add one precisely recalled authority; do not substitute a generic foreign-policy or unity essay.

Compression guidance: Preserve the thesis, four strongest evidence units, one counterpoint and the verdict.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE 7 - 15 marks - 250 words

Question: How do domestic inclusion and federal consultation strengthen India's external policy?

Model answer: Begin with a precise thesis responsive to the directive. Link legitimacy, border regions, State implementation, diaspora, climate and trade to consultation; preserve Union competence while arguing for structured participation. Use constitutional provisions or dated evidence only where they advance the demand. End with a qualified verdict joining legitimacy, institutional capacity and accountability.

Why this earns marks: The answer has a directive-sensitive thesis, an executable evidence order, a limitation and a qualified conclusion.

How to improve this answer: Convert the stated spine into mark-scaled paragraphs and add one precisely recalled authority; do not substitute a generic foreign-policy or unity essay.

Compression guidance: Preserve the thesis, four strongest evidence units, one counterpoint and the verdict.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE 8 - 20 marks - 250 words

Question: Unity without uniformity and autonomy without isolation are complementary principles of Indian statecraft. Analyse.

Model answer: Begin with a precise thesis responsive to the directive. Build two halves: constitutional integration and strategic autonomy; connect them through legitimacy, capability and accountable power; test security and geopolitical constraints. Use constitutional provisions or dated evidence only where they advance the demand. End with a qualified verdict joining legitimacy, institutional capacity and accountability.

Why this earns marks: The answer has a directive-sensitive thesis, an executable evidence order, a limitation and a qualified conclusion.

How to improve this answer: Convert the stated spine into mark-scaled paragraphs and add one precisely recalled authority; do not substitute a generic foreign-policy or unity essay.

Compression guidance: Preserve the thesis, four strongest evidence units, one counterpoint and the verdict.